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OPERATION SINDOOR


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Enough Is Enough

Operation Sindoor demonstrated India's willingness and resolve to use military might if necessary in response to terrorist attacks orchestrated by the enemy on its soil

By PRADIP R. SAGAR

Over the past decade, Indians have been lulled into thinking that terrorist attacks targeting tourists/ pilgrims in Kashmir—occurrences that once happened with horrific regularity—were a thing of the past. That sense of smug satisfaction was shattered on the rolling glades in picturesque Pahalgam on April 22, 2025, when a brutal attack claimed the lives of 26 male tourists. The assault, linked to groups associated with Lashkar-e-Toiba (LeT) and Jaish-e-Mohammed (JeM), was an attempt by Pakistan to disrupt the hard-fought peace in J&K. As indignation and anger surged across the country, many expected a decisive response, such as the 2016 surgical strikes after the Uri terror attack and the 2019 Balakot airstrike following the Pulwama attack.

On May 7, 2025, India launched Operation Sindoor—a series of precision strikes by the Indian Air Force's Rafales and the army's long-range artillery targeting nine Jaish and Lashkar terrorist launchpads inside Pakistan and Pakistan-occupied Kashmir. Satellite images indicated that over a hundred terrorists were eliminated and key command centres destroyed. As Pakistan retaliated, for four intense, dramatic days, the theatre of war was the skies on either side of the Line of Control and the international border. This was modern air warfare at its cutting edge—electronic warfare and smart coordination between aircraft, ground radars and Airborne Warning and Control System aircraft. Hundreds of Pakistani drones and missiles were hurled at Indian airbases, military assets and residential areas, but India's